

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 25

Lamentations

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 25*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Lamentations

Lamentations 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 Oh, oh, oh . . . How empty the city, once teeming with people. A widow, this city, once in the front rank of nations, once queen of the ball, she's now a drudge in the kitchen.
- 1 How deserted lies the city, once so full of people! How like a widow is she, who once was great among the nations! She who was queen among the provinces has now become a slave.
- 2 She cries herself to sleep each night, tears soaking her pillow. No one's left among her lovers to sit and hold her hand. Her friends have all dumped her.
- 2 Bitterly she weeps at night, tears are upon her cheeks. Among all her lovers there is none to comfort her. All her friends have betrayed her; they have become her enemies.
- 3 After years of pain and hard labor, Judah has gone into exile. She camps out among the nations, never feels at home. Hunted by all, she's stuck between a rock and a hard place.
- 3 After affliction and harsh labor, Judah has gone into exile. She dwells among the nations; she finds no resting place. All who pursue her have overtaken her in the midst of her distress.
- 4 Zion's roads weep, empty of pilgrims headed to the feasts. All her city gates are deserted, her priests in despair. Her virgins are sad. How bitter her fate.
- 4 The roads to Zion mourn, for no one comes to her appointed feasts. All her gateways are desolate, her priests groan, her maidens grieve, and she is in bitter anguish.
- 5 Her enemies have become her masters. Her foes are living it up because GOD laid her low, punishing her repeated rebellions. Her children, prisoners of the enemy, trudge into exile.

- 5 Her foes have become her masters; her enemies are at ease. The LORD has brought her grief because of her many sins. Her children have gone into exile, captive before the foe.
- 6 All beauty has drained from Daughter Zion's face. Her princes are like deer famished for food, chased to exhaustion by hunters.
- 6 All the splendor has departed from the Daughter of Zion. Her princes are like deer that find no pasture; in weakness they have fled before the pursuer.
- 7 Jerusalem remembers the day she lost everything, when her people fell into enemy hands, and not a soul there to help. Enemies looked on and laughed, laughed at her helpless silence.
- 7 In the days of her affliction and wandering Jerusalem remembers all the treasures that were hers in days of old. When her people fell into enemy hands, there was no one to help her. Her enemies looked at her and laughed at her destruction.
- 8 Jerusalem, who outsinned the whole world, is an outcast. All who admired her despise her now that they see beneath the surface. Miserable, she groans and turns away in shame.
- 8 Jerusalem has sinned greatly and so has become unclean. All who honored her despise her, for they have seen her nakedness; she herself groans and turns away.
- 9 She played fast and loose with life, she never considered tomorrow, and now she's crashed royally, with no one to hold her hand: "Look at my pain, O GOD! And how the enemy cruelly struts."
- 9 Her filthiness clung to her skirts; she did not consider her future. Her fall was astounding; there was none to comfort her. "Look, O LORD, on my affliction, for the enemy has triumphed."
- 10 The enemy reached out to take all her favorite things. She watched as pagans barged into her Sanctuary, those very people for whom you posted orders: KEEP OUT: THIS ASSEMBLY OFF-LIMITS.
- 10 The enemy laid hands on all her treasures; she saw pagan nations enter her sanctuary-- those you had forbidden to enter your assembly.
- 11 All the people groaned, so desperate for food, so desperate to stay alive that they bartered their favorite things for a bit of breakfast: "O GOD, look at me! Worthless, cheap, abject!"

- 11 All her people groan as they search for bread; they barter their treasures for food to keep themselves alive. "Look, O LORD, and consider, for I am despised."
- 12 "And you passersby, look at me! Have you ever seen anything like this? Ever seen pain like my pain, seen what he did to me, what GOD did to me in his rage?
- 12 Is it nothing to you, all you who pass by? Look around and see. Is any suffering like my suffering that was inflicted on me, that the LORD brought on me in the day of his fierce anger?
- 13 "He struck me with lightning, skewered me from head to foot, then he set traps all around so I could hardly move. He left me with nothing--left me sick, and sick of living.
- 13 From on high he sent fire, sent it down into my bones. He spread a net for my feet and turned me back. He made me desolate, faint all the day long.
- 14 "He wove my sins into a rope and harnessed me to captivity's yoke. I'm goaded by cruel taskmasters.
- 14 My sins have been bound into a yoke; by his hands they were woven together. They have come upon my neck and the Lord has sapped my strength. He has handed me over to those I cannot withstand.
- 15 "The Master piled up my best soldiers in a heap, then called in thugs to break their fine young necks. The Master crushed the life out of fair virgin Judah.
- 15 The Lord has rejected all the warriors in my midst; he has summoned an army against me to crush my young men. In his winepress the Lord has trampled the Virgin Daughter of Judah.
- 16 "For all this I weep, weep buckets of tears, and not a soul within miles around cares for my soul. My children are wasted, my enemy got his way."
- 16 This is why I weep and my eyes overflow with tears. No one is near to comfort me, no one to restore my spirit. My children are destitute because the enemy has prevailed.
- 17 Zion reached out for help, but no one helped. GOD ordered Jacob's enemies to surround him, and now no one wants anything to do with Jerusalem.

- 17 Zion stretches out her hands, but there is no one to comfort her. The LORD has decreed for Jacob that his neighbors become his foes; Jerusalem has become an unclean thing among them.
- 18 "GOD has right on his side. I'm the one who did wrong. Listen everybody! Look at what I'm going through! My fair young women, my fine young men, all herded into exile!
- 18 The LORD is righteous, yet I rebelled against his command. Listen, all you peoples; look upon my suffering. My young men and maidens have gone into exile.
- 19 "I called to my friends; they betrayed me. My priests and my leaders only looked after themselves, trying but failing to save their own skins.
- 19 I called to my allies but they betrayed me. My priests and my elders perished in the city while they searched for food to keep themselves alive.
- 20 "O GOD, look at the trouble I'm in! My stomach in knots, my heart wrecked by a life of rebellion. Massacres in the streets, starvation in the houses.
- 20 See, O LORD, how distressed I am! I am in torment within, and in my heart I am disturbed, for I have been most rebellious. Outside, the sword bereaves; inside, there is only death.
- 21 "Oh, listen to my groans. No one listens, no one cares. When my enemies heard of the trouble you gave me, they cheered. Bring on Judgment Day! Let them get what I got!
- 21 People have heard my groaning, but there is no one to comfort me. All my enemies have heard of my distress; they rejoice at what you have done. May you bring the day you have announced so they may become like me.
- 22 "Take a good look at their evil ways and give it to them! Give them what you gave me for my sins. Groaning in pain, body and soul, I've had all I can take."
- 22 Let all their wickedness come before you; deal with them as you have dealt with me because of all my sins. My groans are many and my heart is faint.

Lamentations 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Oh, oh, oh . . . How the Master has cut down Daughter Zion from the skies, dashed Israel's glorious city to earth, in his anger treated his favorite as throwaway junk.
- 1 How the Lord has covered the Daughter of Zion with the cloud of his anger! He has hurled down the splendor of Israel from heaven to earth; he has not remembered his footstool in the day of his anger.
- 2 The Master, without a second thought, took Israel in one gulp. Raging, he smashed Judah's defenses, made hash of her king and princes.
- 2 Without pity the Lord has swallowed up all the dwellings of Jacob; in his wrath he has torn down the strongholds of the Daughter of Judah. He has brought her kingdom and its princes down to the ground in dishonor.
- 3 His anger blazing, he knocked Israel flat, broke Israel's arm and turned his back just as the enemy approached, came on Jacob like a wildfire from every direction.
- 3 In fierce anger he has cut off every horn of Israel. He has withdrawn his right hand at the approach of the enemy. He has burned in Jacob like a flaming fire that consumes everything around it.
- 4 Like an enemy, he aimed his bow, bared his sword, and killed our young men, our pride and joy. His anger, like fire, burned down the homes in Zion.
- 4 Like an enemy he has strung his bow; his right hand is ready. Like a foe he has slain all who were pleasing to the eye; he has poured out his wrath like fire on the tent of the Daughter of Zion.
- 5 The Master became the enemy. He had Israel for supper. He chewed up and spit out all the defenses. He left Daughter Judah moaning and groaning.
- 5 The Lord is like an enemy; he has swallowed up Israel. He has swallowed up all her palaces and destroyed her strongholds. He has multiplied mourning and lamentation for the Daughter of Judah.
- 6 He plowed up his old trysting place, trashed his favorite rendezvous. GOD wiped out Zion's memories of feast days and Sabbaths, angrily sacked king and priest alike.
- 6 He has laid waste his dwelling like a garden; he has destroyed his place of meeting. The LORD has made Zion forget her appointed feasts and

- her Sabbaths; in his fierce anger he has spurned both king and priest.
- 7 GOD abandoned his altar, walked away from his holy Temple and turned the fortifications over to the enemy. As they cheered in GOD's Temple, you'd have thought it was a feast day!
- 7 The Lord has rejected his altar and abandoned his sanctuary. He has handed over to the enemy the walls of her palaces; they have raised a shout in the house of the LORD as on the day of an appointed feast.
- 8 GOD drew up plans to tear down the walls of Daughter Zion. He assembled his crew, set to work and went at it. Total demolition! The stones wept!
- 8 The LORD determined to tear down the wall around the Daughter of Zion. He stretched out a measuring line and did not withhold his hand from destroying. He made ramparts and walls lament; together they wasted away.
- 9 Her city gates, iron bars and all, disappeared in the rubble: her kings and princes off to exile--no one left to instruct or lead; her prophets useless--they neither saw nor heard anything from GOD.
- 9 Her gates have sunk into the ground; their bars he has broken and destroyed. Her king and her princes are exiled among the nations, the law is no more, and her prophets no longer find visions from the LORD.
- 10 The elders of Daughter Zion sit silent on the ground. They throw dust on their heads, dress in rough penitential burlap-- the young virgins of Jerusalem, their faces creased with the dirt.
- 10 The elders of the Daughter of Zion sit on the ground in silence; they have sprinkled dust on their heads and put on sackcloth. The young women of Jerusalem have bowed their heads to the ground.
- 11 My eyes are blind with tears, my stomach in a knot. My insides have turned to jelly over my people's fate. Babies and children are fainting all over the place,
- 11 My eyes fail from weeping, I am in torment within, my heart is poured out on the ground because my people are destroyed, because children and infants faint in the streets of the city.
- 12 Calling to their mothers, "I'm hungry! I'm thirsty!" then fainting like dying soldiers in the streets, breathing their last in their mothers' laps.
- 12 They say to their mothers, "Where is bread and wine?" as they faint like wounded men in the streets of the city, as their lives ebb away in their

mothers' arms.

- 13 How can I understand your plight, dear Jerusalem? What can I say to give you comfort, dear Zion? Who can put you together again? This bust-up is past understanding.
- 13 What can I say for you? With what can I compare you, O Daughter of Jerusalem? To what can I liken you, that I may comfort you, O Virgin Daughter of Zion? Your wound is as deep as the sea. Who can heal you?
- 14 Your prophets courted you with sweet talk. They didn't face you with your sin so that you could repent. Their sermons were all wishful thinking, deceptive illusions.
- 14 The visions of your prophets were false and worthless; they did not expose your sin to ward off your captivity. The oracles they gave you were false and misleading.
- 15 Astonished, passersby can't believe what they see. They rub their eyes, they shake their heads over Jerusalem. Is this the city voted "Most Beautiful" and "Best Place to Live"?
- 15 All who pass your way clap their hands at you; they scoff and shake their heads at the Daughter of Jerusalem: "Is this the city that was called the perfection of beauty, the joy of the whole earth?"
- 16 But now your enemies gape, slack-jawed. Then they rub their hands in glee: "We've got them! We've been waiting for this! Here it is!"
- 16 All your enemies open their mouths wide against you; they scoff and gnash their teeth and say, "We have swallowed her up. This is the day we have waited for; we have lived to see it."
- 17 GOD did carry out, item by item, exactly what he said he'd do. He always said he'd do this. Now he's done it--torn the place down. He's let your enemies walk all over you, declared them world champions!
- 17 The LORD has done what he planned; he has fulfilled his word, which he decreed long ago. He has overthrown you without pity, he has let the enemy gloat over you, he has exalted the horn of your foes.
- 18 Give out heart-cries to the Master, dear repentant Zion. Let the tears roll like a river, day and night, and keep at it--no time-outs. Keep those tears flowing!
- 18 The hearts of the people cry out to the Lord. O wall of the Daughter of Zion, let your tears flow like a river day and night; give yourself no relief, your eyes no rest.

- 19 As each night watch begins, get up and cry out in prayer. Pour your heart out face to face with the Master. Lift high your hands. Beg for the lives of your children who are starving to death out on the streets.
- 19 Arise, cry out in the night, as the watches of the night begin; pour out your heart like water in the presence of the Lord. Lift up your hands to him for the lives of your children, who faint from hunger at the head of every street.
- 20 "Look at us, GOD. Think it over. Have you ever treated anyone like this? Should women eat their own babies, the very children they raised? Should priests and prophets be murdered in the Master's own Sanctuary?
- 20 Look, O LORD, and consider: Whom have you ever treated like this? Should women eat their offspring, the children they have cared for? Should priest and prophet be killed in the sanctuary of the Lord?
- 21 "Boys and old men lie in the gutters of the streets, my young men and women killed in their prime. Angry, you killed them in cold blood, cut them down without mercy.
- 21 Young and old lie together in the dust of the streets; my young men and maidens have fallen by the sword. You have slain them in the day of your anger; you have slaughtered them without pity.
- 22 "You invited, like friends to a party, men to swoop down in attack so that on the big day of GOD's wrath no one would get away. The children I loved and reared--gone, gone, gone."
- 22 As you summon to a feast day, so you summoned against me terrors on every side. In the day of the LORD's anger no one escaped or survived; those I cared for and reared, my enemy has destroyed.

Lamentations 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 I'm the man who has seen trouble, trouble coming from the lash of GOD's anger.
- 1 I am the man who has seen affliction by the rod of his wrath.
- 2 He took me by the hand and walked me into pitch-black darkness.
- 2 He has driven me away and made me walk in darkness rather than light;
- 3 Yes, he's given me the back of his hand over and over and over again.

3 indeed, he has turned his hand against me again and again, all day long.
4 He turned me into a scarecrow of skin and bones, then broke the bones.
4 He has made my skin and my flesh grow old and has broken my bones.
5 He hemmed me in, ganged up on me, poured on the trouble and hard times.
5 He has besieged me and surrounded me with bitterness and hardship.
6 He locked me up in deep darkness, like a corpse nailed inside a coffin.
6 He has made me dwell in darkness like those long dead.
7 He shuts me in so I'll never get out, manacles my hands, shackles my feet.
7 He has walled me in so I cannot escape; he has weighed me down with chains.
8 Even when I cry out and plead for help, he locks up my prayers and throws away the key.
8 Even when I call out or cry for help, he shuts out my prayer.
9 He sets up blockades with quarried limestone. He's got me cornered.
9 He has barred my way with blocks of stone; he has made my paths crooked.
10 He's a prowling bear tracking me down, a lion in hiding ready to pounce.
10 Like a bear lying in wait, like a lion in hiding,
11 He knocked me from the path and ripped me to pieces. When he finished, there was nothing left of me.
11 he dragged me from the path and mangled me and left me without help.
12 He took out his bow and arrows and used me for target practice.
12 He drew his bow and made me the target for his arrows.
13 He shot me in the stomach with arrows from his quiver.
13 He pierced my heart with arrows from his quiver.
14 Everyone took me for a joke, made me the butt of their mocking ballads.
14 I became the laughingstock of all my people; they mock me in song all day long.
15 He forced rotten, stinking food down my throat, bloated me with vile drinks.
15 He has filled me with bitter herbs and sated me with gall.
16 He ground my face into the gravel. He pounded me into the mud.

16 He has broken my teeth with gravel; he has trampled me in the dust.
17 I gave up on life altogether. I've forgotten what the good life is like.
17 I have been deprived of peace; I have forgotten what prosperity is.
18 I said to myself, "This is it. I'm finished. GOD is a lost cause."
18 So I say, "My splendor is gone and all that I had hoped from the LORD."
19 I'll never forget the trouble, the utter lostness, the taste of ashes, the poison I've swallowed.
19 I remember my affliction and my wandering, the bitterness and the gall.
20 I remember it all--oh, how well I remember-- the feeling of hitting the bottom.
20 I well remember them, and my soul is downcast within me.
21 But there's one other thing I remember, and remembering, I keep a grip on hope:
21 Yet this I call to mind and therefore I have hope:
22 GOD's loyal love couldn't have run out, his merciful love couldn't have dried up.
22 Because of the LORD's great love we are not consumed, for his compassions never fail.
23 They're created new every morning. How great your faithfulness!
23 They are new every morning; great is your faithfulness.
24 I'm sticking with GOD (I say it over and over). He's all I've got left.
24 I say to myself, "The LORD is my portion; therefore I will wait for him."
25 GOD proves to be good to the man who passionately waits, to the woman who diligently seeks.
25 The LORD is good to those whose hope is in him, to the one who seeks him;
26 It's a good thing to quietly hope, quietly hope for help from GOD.
26 it is good to wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD.
27 It's a good thing when you're young to stick it out through the hard times.
27 It is good for a man to bear the yoke while he is young.
28 When life is heavy and hard to take, go off by yourself. Enter the silence.
28 Let him sit alone in silence, for the LORD has laid it on him.

29 Bow in prayer. Don't ask questions: Wait for hope to appear.
29 Let him bury his face in the dust-- there may yet be hope.
30 Don't run from trouble. Take it full-face. The "worst" is never the worst.
30 Let him offer his cheek to one who would strike him, and let him be filled with disgrace.
31 Why? Because the Master won't ever walk out and fail to return.
31 For men are not cast off by the Lord forever.
32 If he works severely, he also works tenderly. His stockpiles of loyal love are immense.
32 Though he brings grief, he will show compassion, so great is his unfailing love.
33 He takes no pleasure in making life hard, in throwing roadblocks in the way:
33 For he does not willingly bring affliction or grief to the children of men.
34 Stomping down hard on luckless prisoners,
34 To crush underfoot all prisoners in the land,
35 Refusing justice to victims in the court of High God,
35 to deny a man his rights before the Most High,
36 Tampering with evidence-- the Master does not approve of such things.
36 to deprive a man of justice-- would not the Lord see such things?
37 Who do you think "spoke and it happened"? It's the Master who gives such orders.
37 Who can speak and have it happen if the Lord has not decreed it?
38 Doesn't the High God speak everything, good things and hard things alike, into being?
38 Is it not from the mouth of the Most High that both calamities and good things come?
39 And why would anyone gifted with life complain when punished for sin?
39 Why should any living man complain when punished for his sins?
40 Let's take a good look at the way we're living and reorder our lives under GOD.
40 Let us examine our ways and test them, and let us return to the LORD.
41 Let's lift our hearts and hands at one and the same time, praying to God in heaven:
41 Let us lift up our hearts and our hands to God in heaven, and say:

42 "We've been contrary and willful, and you haven't forgiven.
42 We have sinned and rebelled and you have not forgiven.
43 "You lost your temper with us, holding nothing back. You chased us and
cut us down without mercy.
43 You have covered yourself with anger and pursued us; you have slain
without pity.
44 You wrapped yourself in thick blankets of clouds so no prayers could
get through.
44 You have covered yourself with a cloud so that no prayer can get
through.
45 You treated us like dirty dishwater, threw us out in the backyard of the
nations.
45 You have made us scum and refuse among the nations.
46 "Our enemies shout abuse, their mouths full of derision, spitting
invective.
46 All our enemies have opened their mouths wide against us.
47 We've been to hell and back. We've nowhere to turn, nowhere to go.
47 We have suffered terror and pitfalls, ruin and destruction."
48 Rivers of tears pour from my eyes at the smashup of my dear people.
48 Streams of tears flow from my eyes because my people are destroyed.
49 "The tears stream from my eyes, an artesian well of tears,
49 My eyes will flow unceasingly, without relief,
50 Until you, GOD, look down from on high, look and see my tears.
50 until the LORD looks down from heaven and sees.
51 When I see what's happened to the young women in the city, the pain
breaks my heart.
51 What I see brings grief to my soul because of all the women of my city.
52 "Enemies with no reason to be enemies hunted me down like a bird.
52 Those who were my enemies without cause hunted me like a bird.
53 They threw me into a pit, then pelted me with stones.
53 They tried to end my life in a pit and threw stones at me;
54 Then the rains came and filled the pit. The water rose over my head. I
said, 'It's all over.'
54 the waters closed over my head, and I thought I was about to be cut off.
55 "I called out your name, O GOD, called from the bottom of the pit.
55 I called on your name, O LORD, from the depths of the pit.

56 You listened when I called out, 'Don't shut your ears! Get me out of here! Save me!'

56 You heard my plea: "Do not close your ears to my cry for relief."

57 You came close when I called out. You said, 'It's going to be all right.'

57 You came near when I called you, and you said, "Do not fear."

58 "You took my side, Master; you brought me back alive!

58 O Lord, you took up my case; you redeemed my life.

59 GOD, you saw the wrongs heaped on me. Give me my day in court!

59 You have seen, O LORD, the wrong done to me. Uphold my cause!

60 Yes, you saw their mean-minded schemes, their plots to destroy me.

60 You have seen the depth of their vengeance, all their plots against me.

61 "You heard, GOD, their vicious gossip, their behind-my-back plots to ruin me.

61 O LORD, you have heard their insults, all their plots against me--

62 They never quit, these enemies of mine, dreaming up mischief, hatching out malice, day after day after day.

62 what my enemies whisper and mutter against me all day long.

63 Sitting down or standing up--just look at them!-- they mock me with vulgar doggerel.

63 Look at them! Sitting or standing, they mock me in their songs.

64 "Make them pay for what they've done, GOD. Give them their just deserts.

64 Pay them back what they deserve, O LORD, for what their hands have done.

65 Break their miserable hearts! Damn their eyes!

65 Put a veil over their hearts, and may your curse be on them!

66 Get good and angry. Hunt them down. Make a total demolition here under your heaven!"

66 Pursue them in anger and destroy them from under the heavens of the LORD.

Lamentations 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Oh, oh, oh . . . How gold is treated like dirt, the finest gold thrown out with the garbage, Priceless jewels scattered all over, jewels loose in the gutters.
- 1 How the gold has lost its luster, the fine gold become dull! The sacred gems are scattered at the head of every street.
- 2 And the people of Zion, once prized, far surpassing their weight in gold, Are now treated like cheap pottery, like everyday pots and bowls mass-produced by a potter.
- 2 How the precious sons of Zion, once worth their weight in gold, are now considered as pots of clay, the work of a potter's hands!
- 3 Even wild jackals nurture their babies, give them their breasts to suckle. But my people have turned cruel to their babies, like an ostrich in the wilderness.
- 3 Even jackals offer their breasts to nurse their young, but my people have become heartless like ostriches in the desert.
- 4 Babies have nothing to drink. Their tongues stick to the roofs of their mouths. Little children ask for bread but no one gives them so much as a crust.
- 4 Because of thirst the infant's tongue sticks to the roof of its mouth; the children beg for bread, but no one gives it to them.
- 5 People used to the finest cuisine forage for food in the streets. People used to the latest in fashions pick through the trash for something to wear.
- 5 Those who once ate delicacies are destitute in the streets. Those nurtured in purple now lie on ash heaps.
- 6 The evil guilt of my dear people was worse than the sin of Sodom-- The city was destroyed in a flash, and no one around to help.
- 6 The punishment of my people is greater than that of Sodom, which was overthrown in a moment without a hand turned to help her.
- 7 The splendid and sacred nobles once glowed with health. Their bodies were robust and ruddy, their beards like carved stone.
- 7 Their princes were brighter than snow and whiter than milk, their bodies more ruddy than rubies, their appearance like sapphires.
- 8 But now they are smeared with soot, unrecognizable in the street, Their bones sticking out, their skin dried out like old leather.

- 8 But now they are blacker than soot; they are not recognized in the streets.
Their skin has shriveled on their bones; it has become as dry as a stick.
- 9 Better to have been killed in battle than killed by starvation. Better to
have died of battle wounds than to slowly starve to death.
- 9 Those killed by the sword are better off than those who die of famine;
racked with hunger, they waste away for lack of food from the field.
- 10 Nice and kindly women boiled their own children for supper. This was
the only food in town when my dear people were broken.
- 10 With their own hands compassionate women have cooked their own
children, who became their food when my people were destroyed.
- 11 GOD let all his anger loose, held nothing back. He poured out his raging
wrath. He set a fire in Zion that burned it to the ground.
- 11 The LORD has given full vent to his wrath; he has poured out his fierce
anger. He kindled a fire in Zion that consumed her foundations.
- 12 The kings of the earth couldn't believe it. World rulers were in shock,
Watching old enemies march in big as you please, right through
Jerusalem's gates.
- 12 The kings of the earth did not believe, nor did any of the world's people,
that enemies and foes could enter the gates of Jerusalem.
- 13 Because of the sins of her prophets and the evil of her priests, Who
exploited good and trusting people, robbing them of their lives,
- 13 But it happened because of the sins of her prophets and the iniquities of
her priests, who shed within her the blood of the righteous.
- 14 These prophets and priests blindly grope their way through the streets,
grimy and stained from their dirty lives, Wasted by their wasted lives,
shuffling from fatigue, dressed in rags.
- 14 Now they grope through the streets like men who are blind. They are so
defiled with blood that no one dares to touch their garments.
- 15 People yell at them, "Get out of here, dirty old men! Get lost, don't
touch us, don't infect us!" They have to leave town. They wander off.
Nobody wants them to stay here. Everyone knows, wherever they
wander, that they've been kicked out of their own hometown.
- 15 Go away! You are unclean! men cry to them. "Away! Away! Don't
touch us!" When they flee and wander about, people among the nations
say, "They can stay here no longer."

- 16 GOD himself scattered them. No longer does he look out for them. He has nothing to do with the priests; he cares nothing for the elders.
- 16 The LORD himself has scattered them; he no longer watches over them. The priests are shown no honor, the elders no favor.
- 17 We watched and watched, wore our eyes out looking for help. And nothing. We mounted our lookouts and looked for the help that never showed up.
- 17 Moreover, our eyes failed, looking in vain for help; from our towers we watched for a nation that could not save us.
- 18 They tracked us down, those hunters. It wasn't safe to go out in the street. Our end was near, our days numbered. We were doomed.
- 18 Men stalked us at every step, so we could not walk in our streets. Our end was near, our days were numbered, for our end had come.
- 19 They came after us faster than eagles in flight, pressed us hard in the mountains, ambushed us in the desert.
- 19 Our pursuers were swifter than eagles in the sky; they chased us over the mountains and lay in wait for us in the desert.
- 20 Our king, our life's breath, the anointed of GOD, was caught in their traps-- Our king under whose protection we always said we'd live.
- 20 The LORD's anointed, our very life breath, was caught in their traps. We thought that under his shadow we would live among the nations.
- 21 Celebrate while you can, O Edom! Live it up in Uz! For it won't be long before you drink this cup, too. You'll find out what it's like to drink God's wrath, Get drunk on God's wrath and wake up with nothing, stripped naked.
- 21 Rejoice and be glad, O Daughter of Edom, you who live in the land of Uz. But to you also the cup will be passed; you will be drunk and stripped naked.
- 22 And that's it for you, Zion. The punishment's complete. You won't have to go through this exile again. But Edom, your time is coming: He'll punish your evil life, put all your sins on display.
- 22 O Daughter of Zion, your punishment will end; he will not prolong your exile. But, O Daughter of Edom, he will punish your sin and expose your wickedness.

Lamentations 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Remember, GOD, all we've been through. Study our plight, the black mark we've made in history.
- 1 Remember, O LORD, what has happened to us; look, and see our disgrace.
- 2 Our precious land has been given to outsiders, our homes to strangers.
- 2 Our inheritance has been turned over to aliens, our homes to foreigners.
- 3 Orphans we are, not a father in sight, and our mothers no better than widows.
- 3 We have become orphans and fatherless, our mothers like widows.
- 4 We have to pay to drink our own water. Even our firewood comes at a price.
- 4 We must buy the water we drink; our wood can be had only at a price.
- 5 We're nothing but slaves, bullied and bowed, worn out and without any rest.
- 5 Those who pursue us are at our heels; we are weary and find no rest.
- 6 We sold ourselves to Assyria and Egypt just to get something to eat.
- 6 We submitted to Egypt and Assyria to get enough bread.
- 7 Our parents sinned and are no more, and now we're paying for the wrongs they did.
- 7 Our fathers sinned and are no more, and we bear their punishment.
- 8 Slaves rule over us; there's no escape from their grip.
- 8 Slaves rule over us, and there is none to free us from their hands.
- 9 We risk our lives to gather food in the bandit-infested desert.
- 9 We get our bread at the risk of our lives because of the sword in the desert.
- 10 Our skin has turned black as an oven, dried out like old leather from the famine.
- 10 Our skin is hot as an oven, feverish from hunger.
- 11 Our wives were raped in the streets in Zion, and our virgins in the cities of Judah.
- 11 Women have been ravished in Zion, and virgins in the towns of Judah.
- 12 They hanged our princes by their hands, dishonored our elders.

12 Princes have been hung up by their hands; elders are shown no respect.
13 Strapping young men were put to women's work, mere boys forced to do men's work.
13 Young men toil at the millstones; boys stagger under loads of wood.
14 The city gate is empty of wise elders. Music from the young is heard no more.
14 The elders are gone from the city gate; the young men have stopped their music.
15 All the joy is gone from our hearts. Our dances have turned into dirges.
15 Joy is gone from our hearts; our dancing has turned to mourning.
16 The crown of glory has toppled from our head. Woe! Woe! Would that we'd never sinned!
16 The crown has fallen from our head. Woe to us, for we have sinned!
17 Because of all this we're heartsick; we can't see through the tears.
17 Because of this our hearts are faint, because of these things our eyes grow dim
18 On Mount Zion, wrecked and ruined, jackals pace and prowl.
18 for Mount Zion, which lies desolate, with jackals prowling over it.
19 And yet, GOD, you're sovereign still, your throne intact and eternal.
19 You, O LORD, reign forever; your throne endures from generation to generation.
20 So why do you keep forgetting us? Why dump us and leave us like this?
20 Why do you always forget us? Why do you forsake us so long?
21 Bring us back to you, GOD--we're ready to come back. Give us a fresh start.
21 Restore us to yourself, O LORD, that we may return; renew our days as of old
22 As it is, you've cruelly disowned us. You've been so very angry with us."
22 unless you have utterly rejected us and are angry with us beyond measure.